

of what Aja had to say about how we can be kinder to ourselves and the planet were aligned with the pathways and values that we explore throughout this book, and how the wider ripple effects of our personal journeys towards financial wellbeing could create a social and environmental impact too. Sometimes it helps, when we're not feeling inclined to be led by our finances on these decisions, to have other reasons to challenge hedonic adaption and learn to live better, with less.

Easing spending anxiety

Much of the focus of the spending discourse tends to focus around the habit of spending *too much*, but there are a lot of people out there who struggle to bring themselves to spend anything at all, or experience terrible anxiety after parting with any amount of cash. In some ways, it's understandable that we focus on those who are haemorrhaging cash at an alarming rate, because this is the practice that poses the most immediate and direct threat to financial health; quite literally, the money is leaving the building, and we need to try to stop it, because it's difficult to have a good relationship with money that's no longer in your possession. Even in this book, a lot of time is given to helping you to understand why you might struggle to curb spending that's tied to emotions rather than conscious, logical decision-making, but spending too much or too freely is not the only way in which it's possible for your spending habits to influence your financial wellbeing.